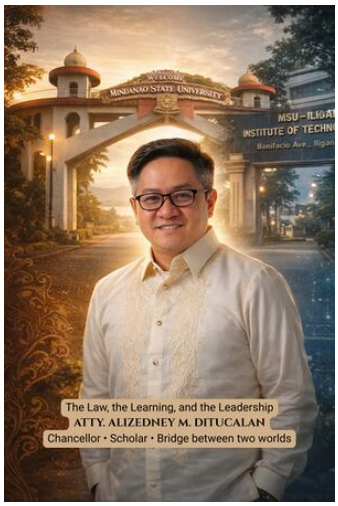
Alizedney M. Ditucalan

Alizedney "Zed" M. Ditucalan (born in Bacolod-Kalawi, Lanao del Sur) is a Maranao lawyer, competition law scholar, and the fourth Chancellor of Mindanao State University-Iligan Institute of Technology (MSU-IIT). Elected on February 28, 2022, by the MSU Board of Regents, he became the youngest person and the first alumnus ever to lead the institution. More than a biographical milestone, that homecoming captures the through-line of his career: a commitment to building institutions, not just inhabiting them. Whether he was designing the Sarimanok Virtual Law Clinic to bring legal services to remote Lanao del Norte communities, arguing in international handbooks that the Philippine Competition Act is a flawed but salvageable regulatory transplant, or convening the first-ever MSU System-wide Academic Summit, Ditucalan has consistently framed his work around one conviction: that a well-designed institution serves its people far better than a poorly designed one, however eloquently worded its founding documents may be.

Alizedney M. Ditucalan



Title	Chancellor, Mindanao State University-Iligan Institute of Technology
In office	July 12, 2022 – present
Preceded by	Dr. Sukarno D. Tanggol
Birthplace	Bacolod-Kalawi, Lanao del Sur, Philippines
Ethnicity	Maranao
Religion	Islam
Nationality	Filipino
Alma mater	Mindanao State University Main Campus (J.D.) Kyushu University (LL.M.) KU Leuven (graduate studies)
Profession	Lawyer, Legal Scholar, Academic Administrator
Known for	4th Chancellor of MSU-IIT; Competition Law Scholarship; Sarimanok Virtual Law Clinic

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Background and Early Life

Ditucalan grew up in Bacolod-Kalawi in Lanao del Sur, in the cultural orbit of the Mindanao State University main campus in Marawi City. That campus, established in 1961 as what its founding legislation called a "social laboratory" for peace and integration, has always been more than a university; it is a statement about the place of the Bangsamoro in the Philippine national fabric.<ref name="iit-history">MSU-IIT History, 54th Charter Day website, Mindanao State University-Iligan Institute of Technology, accessed March 10, 2026. Available at: https://sites.google.com/g.msuiit.edu.ph/54thcharterday/iit-history</ref> Growing up in proximity to it gave Ditucalan an early exposure to the layered world of Muslim Mindanao's legal life: a world where customary Maranao norms, specifically the *Taritib* and *Igma* that have governed community relations for centuries, sit alongside a civil legal system whose authority over local disputes has never been entirely uncontested.<ref name="bangsamoro-context">On Maranao customary law and the MSU social laboratory mandate, see MSU IIT History (ibid., note 1). The concept of Taritib and Igma as traditional legal norms operating alongside civil law is widely acknowledged in Bangsamoro legal literature, including the Bangsamoro Education Code of 2021.</ref>

That environment was, in effect, his first classroom in legal theory. Long before he ever read a regulatory economics textbook in Japan, he had already absorbed the practical lesson that law does not operate in a vacuum: it is always in conversation with history, with faith, and with the particular grievances and aspirations of the community it purports to govern.

Education

Juris Doctor at MSU Marawi

Ditucalan completed his Juris Doctor at the MSU College of Law on the main campus in Marawi City. Legal education at Marawi has always had a distinct character. Its students come of age understanding that law in Muslim Mindanao is never purely abstract: the tension between Islamic jurisprudence and secular civil procedure is lived, not merely theorized. That formation would leave a permanent mark on Ditucalan's scholarly sensibility, particularly in his later work on regulatory design, where his skepticism about transplanting foreign legal frameworks onto unfamiliar soil has deep personal and historical roots.

Master of Laws, Kyushu University

After his initial years in practice, Ditucalan was selected for the Young Leaders' Program (YLP), a scholarship administered under Japan's Ministry of Education, Culture, Sports, Science and Technology (MEXT), designed to cultivate future policy leaders from Asian nations and foster durable intellectual connections with Japan.<ref name="mext-ylp">Young Leaders' Program, Ministry of Education, Culture, Sports, Science and Technology (MEXT), Japan. Available at: https://www.mext.go.jp/en/policy/education/highered/title02/detail02/sdetail02/sdetail02/1374094.htm</ref> He was the first recipient from Mindanao to be selected for the program, a distinction that reflected both the strength of his candidacy and the degree to which Mindanao had historically been passed over in elite international fellowship pipelines.<ref name="pmt">Ditucalan assumes as MSU-IIT new chancellor, Philippine Muslim Today, March 14, 2022. Available at: https://philmuslimtoday.com/2022/03/14/ditucalan-assumes-as-msu-iit-new-chancellor/</ref>

At the Kyushu University Graduate School of Law, he completed an LL.M. in International Economic and Business Law with a specialization in Competition Law. The curriculum required twenty academic credits and a master's thesis of at least fifty pages, drawing on comparative regulatory frameworks from the United States, the European Union, and Japan.<ref name="kyushu-ylp">Young Leaders' Program (YLP) in Law (LL.M.), Kyushu University Graduate School of Law. Available at: https://www.law.kyushu-u.ac.jp/programsinenglish/html/programs-admissions/academic-programs/ylp-ll-m/</ref> The experience also gave him something harder to quantify: a deep familiarity with the Japanese administrative culture of long-term planning, accountability structured around clear metrics, and what he would later describe as the institutional value of "predictability."<ref name="msu-newsletter">MSU Newsletter, March 2023, MSU Main Campus. Available at: https://www.msumain.edu.ph/wp-content/uploads/2025/03/01-2023-March-MSU-Newsletter.pdf</ref>

Graduate Studies at KU Leuven

Alongside his Japan-based training, Ditucalan completed additional graduate coursework at the Katholieke Universiteit Leuven (KU Leuven) in Belgium, deepening his grounding in European competition law and comparative regulatory theory.<ref name="pmt"/>

Doctoral Research at Kyushu University

Ditucalan was subsequently selected under the JICA Knowledge Co-Creation Program (KCCP) as the first Filipino long-term scholar of the Japan International Cooperation Agency (JICA) to undertake doctoral research at Kyushu University's Graduate School of Law. He was also the first Filipino lawyer to pursue a doctorate specifically in competition law.<ref name="pmt"/> His research focused on the institutional design of Philippine competition law, examining how the architecture of regulatory agencies, not merely the text of the legislation, determines whether a competition regime actually works in practice.<ref name="nexus">Dean Zed Pursues LL.D. in Kyushu University, Japan, The Nexus (MSU Law), February 4, 2018. Available at: https://msulawnexus.wordpress.com/2018/02/04/dean-zed-pursues-ll-d-in-kyushu-univesity-japan/</ref>

A note on credentials: while multiple biographical sources describe Ditucalan as having pursued a Doctor of Laws (LL.D.) at Kyushu, the official MSU-IIT directory lists his academic titles as J.D. and LL.M. only.<ref name="pmt"/> The 2018 announcement in *The Nexus* confirmed that he began his three-year LL.D. program at Kyushu in February 2018.<ref name="nexus"/> The conferral of the LL.D. degree had not been independently confirmed by official institutional records at the time this article was written.

Career

Early Legal Practice

After completing his Juris Doctor, Ditucalan entered public service as a public attorney, essentially a public defender, gaining the front-line litigation experience that would later distinguish his scholarship from more abstract legal theory. He was subsequently appointed University Chief Legal Counsel of the MSU System and Director of the Legal Services Division, roles that required him to navigate the full complexity of institutional law within a multi-campus state university.<ref name="pmt"/> He also served as President of the local chapter of the Integrated Bar of the Philippines and as Managing Partner at Subejano and Ditucalan, handling appellate work.<ref name="pmt"/>

Dean of the MSU College of Law

Ditucalan served as Dean across three campuses of the MSU College of Law, a portfolio reflecting the confidence the MSU System placed in his administrative capacity.<ref name="pmt"/> During this period, he also served as Vice Chancellor for Academic Affairs at MSU-IIT, giving him a comprehensive view of how both legal education and university administration function from the inside.

His most consequential innovation as dean was the creation of the **Sarimanok Virtual Law Clinic** (SVLC), conceptualized in 2019. The SVLC was built on the expanded permissions granted to law student practitioners under the Revised Rule 138-A of the Supreme Court of the Philippines, which broadened the scope of activities law students could undertake under attorney supervision.<ref name="clep">The First of a Thousand Voices: Stories of CLEP in the First Years of the Revised Rule 138-A. Available at: https://fliphtml5.com/qzxkz/torf/The_First_of_a_Thousand_Voices%3A_Stories_of_CLEP_in_the_First_Years_of_the_Revised_Rule_138-A/</ref>

Under Ditucalan's guidance, MSU became one of the first law schools in the country to leverage this expanded framework through a digital delivery model. Students could conduct virtual client interviews and provide supervised legal advice through online platforms, effectively removing the geographic barrier that had historically prevented residents of remote communities in Lanao del Norte from accessing legal services.<ref name="clep"/> The SVLC was not an emergency pandemic response; it was operational before COVID-19 arrived in 2020, making it one of the clearest examples in recent Philippine legal history of institutional leadership anticipating conditions rather than merely reacting to them.

The clinic was developed in conversation with the highest levels of Philippine judicial leadership. Ditucalan participated in consultations with then-Chief Justice Lucas Bersamin and Associate Justice Alexander Gesmundo, and was part of a Philippine delegation that visited Harvard University, Georgetown University, and Suffolk University to study American clinical legal education models.<ref name="pmt"/> The SVLC model has since been documented in *The First of a Thousand Voices*, a publication chronicling the early experience of clinical legal education under the revised rule.<ref name="clep"/>

Election and Investiture as Chancellor of MSU-IIT

When the MSU Board of Regents convened in Manila on February 28, 2022, and elected Ditucalan as the fourth Chancellor of MSU-IIT, the decision carried weight beyond the procedural.<ref name="iit-history"/> He was not only the youngest person to hold the chancellorship in the institution's history; he was also the first of its alumni ever to return as its head, nearly 22 years after his own graduation.<ref name="pmt"/>

His formal investiture took place on July 12, 2022, during MSU-IIT's 54th Charter Day, when MSU System President Atty. Basari D. Mapupuno presented him with the Chancellor's Medallion and the University Mace, the first and only such mace approved by the MSU Board of Regents.<ref name="investiture">Ditucalan lays out 10-year vision for IIT during investiture, MSU-IIT News, July 2022. Available at: https://www.msuiit.edu.ph/news/news-detail.php?id=1473</ref> He succeeded Dr. Sukarno D. Tanggol.<ref name="iit-history"/>

From his first days in office, Ditucalan set a tone that was deliberately different from the detached formality often associated with university leadership. He toured every unit on campus, conducted listening sessions with faculty and staff in their own spaces rather than summoning them to his, and engaged directly with local radio to share his vision with the broader Iligan community.<ref name="one-year">ChanZed's ONE-credible Year at MSU-IIT, MSU-IIT News. Available at: https://www.msuiit.edu.ph/news/news-detail.php?id=1568</ref> In one candid moment, speaking in the easy Visayan that characterizes daily life in Iligan, he admitted that had he known fully what the role entailed, he might have thought twice before accepting it. It was a moment of genuine self-disclosure that his constituents, by all accounts, appreciated.<ref name="one-year"/>

Scholarship and Intellectual Contributions

Competition Law as Institutional Architecture

Ditucalan's standing as one of the Philippines' leading competition law scholars rests on a body of work that is coherent in a way that much legal scholarship is not: every piece contributes to a single sustained argument rather than ranging across disconnected topics.

The backdrop is a specific legislative history. For roughly 25 years, the Philippine Congress struggled to pass a national competition law, leaving the economy exposed to cartel arrangements and the abuse of dominant market positions.<ref name="msu-newsletter"/> When the Philippine Competition Act (PCA) was finally enacted in 2015, it drew on two distinct regulatory traditions: the American model, grounded in economic efficiency analysis, and the European Union model, which foregrounds market structure and restricts dominant firms from excluding rivals.<ref name="elgar">Ditucalan, Alizedney M., The Philippine Competition Law Dilemma: US-EU Fusion and Tension, in Van Uytsel, Hayashi, and Haley (eds.), Research Handbook on Asian Competition Law (Edward Elgar Publishing, 2020). Available at: https://www.e-elgar.com/shop/usd/research-handbook-on-asian-competition-law-9781785361821.html</ref>

In his contribution to the *Research Handbook on Asian Competition Law* (Edward Elgar, 2020), Ditucalan argued that the PCA is better understood as a "fusion" of these two models than as a transplant from either, and that this fusion creates an internal regulatory tension the Philippine Competition Commission (PCC) must navigate on a case-by-case basis.<ref name="elgar"/>

His earlier work, "Institutional Design of Philippine Competition Law," published in the *KLRI Journal of Law and Legislation* in 2018, took a more structural approach: the PCA's effectiveness depends less on its substantive text than on the organizational architecture of the PCC itself. Independence from political interference, technical expertise in the agency's professional staff, and accountability mechanisms that are transparent without being crippling: these, he argued, are the prerequisites for effective competition enforcement in any developing economy, and the Philippines had not yet fully satisfied them at the time of writing.<ref name="klri-2018">Ditucalan, Alizedney M., Institutional Design of Philippine Competition Law, KLRI Journal of Law and Legislation, Volume 8, Number 1 (2018). Available at SSRN: https://papers.ssrn.com/sol3/papers.cfm?abstract_id=3489788</ref>

A 2019 article in the same journal, "The Philippine Competition Act: A Mestiza?," extended the analysis through the lens of mixed legal systems, arguing that the PCA's hybrid American-European-Filipino character creates both flexibility and uncertainty in its application.<ref name="klri-2019">Ditucalan, Alizedney M., The Philippine Competition Act: A Mestiza?, KLRI Journal of Law and Legislation, Volume 9, Number 2 (2019). Available at SSRN: https://papers.ssrn.com/sol3/papers.cfm?abstract_id=3499045</ref> His chapter in *Leniency in Asian Competition Law* (Cambridge University Press, 2022) added a further dimension, examining how cartel self-reporting mechanisms (leniency programs) function in Asian jurisdictions where institutional trust may be lower than in Western contexts.<ref name="cambridge">Ditucalan, Alizedney M., Chapter contribution to Leniency in Asian Competition Law (Cambridge University Press, 2022). Available at: https://www.cambridge.org/core/books/leniency-in-asian-competition-law/</ref>

The core proposition running through all of this work is direct: law reform without institutional reform is insufficient; transplanted legal frameworks require active redesign to function in their recipient environments; and the measure of a competition law is not the elegance of its text but the quality of the agency charged with enforcing it.

Administration as Chancellor

Vision 2032 and "Influencing the Future"

His 10-year strategic vision, **Vision 2032**, was approved by the MSU Board of Regents on December 22, 2022.<ref name="one-year"/> It gave direction and specificity to a trajectory MSU-IIT had been moving toward for years, organized around six pillars: Education; Research and Innovation; Student Support; Public Service; Governance; and Infrastructure.<ref name="investiture"/> The vision's five-year operational plan carries the tagline "Influencing the Future," and the phrase is more than marketing: it captures Ditucalan's conviction that a regional university's highest obligation is not to mirror what institutions elsewhere have already achieved, but to shape what comes next.

The "One MSU" Mandate

One of the most ambitious of Ditucalan's early initiatives was convening the 2022 MSU System-wide Academic Summit, the first in the MSU System's history.<ref name="msu-newsletter"/> Bringing together academic heads from all thirteen MSU campuses, the summit addressed faculty development pathways, learning outcomes alignment with international benchmarks, blended and digital-first teaching methods, program alignment across campuses, student support services, and quality assurance mechanisms.

The goal was not to make every campus identical, but to achieve what Ditucalan consistently calls "systemness": the coherence of shared standards and shared ambitions operating through institutional diversity.<ref name="msu-newsletter"/> This "One MSU" philosophy carries particular resonance given the historical complexity of the relationship between MSU-Marawi and MSU-IIT, two campuses roughly 90 kilometers apart, in different provinces, with different demographic compositions and primary disciplines. By positioning MSU-IIT as a partner of the main campus rather than a rival, and by embodying that position through his own biography as a Marawi-formed scholar leading the Iligan institution, Ditucalan has sought to make the integration he advocates personally credible.<ref name="investiture"/>

Research Intensity and Rankings

At the time of Ditucalan's appointment, the data offered both encouragement and urgency. In 2022, MSU-IIT broke into the Times Higher Education Impact Rankings, placing in the 801-1000 band in recognition of its performance against the United Nations Sustainable Development Goals.<ref name="iit-history"/> In the QS World University Rankings: Asia, it had held a position in the 551-600 range for several consecutive years, with academic reputation as its strongest asset.<ref name="wiki-msuiit">Mindanao State University-Iligan Institute of Technology, Wikipedia, accessed March 10, 2026. Available at: https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Mindanao_State_University%E2%80%93Iligan_Institute_of_Technology</ref> In the Webometrics Ranking, MSU-IIT had climbed to sixth among Philippine institutions in July 2021, and ranked fourth among Philippine universities in the UI GreenMetric worldwide rankings.<ref name="iit-history"/> In the same year, it received ISO 9001:2015 certification.<ref name="iit-history"/>

Physics Professor Jan Mickelle Maratas was ranked as the Philippines' top scientist by the AD Scientific Index in 2022, a recognition that reflected the kind of sustained investment in individual researchers that Ditucalan's administration has worked to amplify and institutionalize.<ref name="iit-history"/> The university's designation as the first Center for Sustainable Polymers in the Philippines reinforced the seriousness of its research ambitions.

His administration has also pursued active partnerships with the Department of Science and Technology. A 2022 visit to the DOST Advanced Science and Technology Institute (DOST-ASTI) explored collaborative work in satellite data science under the PEDRO initiative, AI-assisted agricultural applications through the Gul.AI platform, and disaster risk mitigation.<ref name="dost">DOST-ASTI Features Initiatives to MSU-IIT, DOST Advanced Science and Technology Institute, 2022. Available at: https://asti.dost.gov.ph/communications/dost-asti-features-initiatives-to-msu-iit/</ref>

Industry Partnerships and Micro-credentials

At the Times Higher Education Asia Universities Summit in 2023, Ditucalan elaborated a practical argument about the future of university credentials: that automation and artificial intelligence will simultaneously displace existing jobs and generate demand for competencies that conventional degree programs do not yet supply.<ref name="the-summit">Agenda and Speaker Profile, Alizedney Ditucalan, THE Asia Universities Summit 2023. Available at: https://www.timeshighered-events.com/asia-universities-summit-2023/agenda/speakers/3070008</ref> His response has been to forge partnerships with Coursera and with global technology firms including Google, Meta, and IBM, embedding professional certificates into the MSU-IIT curriculum as stackable credentials that complement academic degrees and are legible to employers in markets far beyond Iligan.<ref name="the-summit"/>

On the international academic front, he has continued to cultivate his relationship with Kyushu University, facilitating faculty exchanges and joint research, and has pursued collaborative programs with the University of the Philippines Diliman.<ref name="nexus"/> In 2025, MSU-IIT formalized a strategic partnership with Thailand's Bansomdejchaopraya Rajabhat University through a memorandum of understanding, extending the university's internationalization agenda into Southeast Asia.<ref name="msuiit-mou">MSU-IIT and Thailand's Bansomdejchaopraya Rajabhat University forge strategic partnership through MOU, MSU-IIT News, 2025. Available at: https://www.msuiit.edu.ph/news</ref>

Equity, Inclusion, and Peace Education

The values that appear in Ditucalan's policy decisions are consistent with those that appear in his scholarship: that institutions earn legitimacy through transparency and accountability, and that an institution failing to serve all of its constituents is, by definition, poorly designed.

One notable example is the implementation of an inclusive dress code policy at MSU-IIT, which permits students to wear attire corresponding to their gender identity and preference.<ref name="pia">Education, PIA Northern Mindanao (WordPress), accessed March 10, 2026. Available at: https://pianormin.wordpress.com/tag/education/</ref> In a region where conservative social norms carry real weight, and at a university drawing students from across Mindanao's diverse communities, this was an institutional statement with implications far beyond dress codes. Ditucalan explained it in straightforward terms: a learning environment must be one where every student feels safe and respected, and that principle extends to the most visible markers of identity.<ref name="pia"/>

In 2024, under his oversight, MSU-IIT approved a formal Peace Education Policy and moved to strengthen the Institute for Peace and Development in Mindanao (IPDM).<ref name="msu-2024">MSU Newsletter, September 2024, MSU Main Campus. Available at: https://www.msumain.edu.ph/wp-content/uploads/2025/03/05-2024-September-MSU-Newsletter.pdf</ref> These steps align with the Bangsamoro Education Code of 2021, which calls for the integration of peace education across all levels of the school system in the Bangsamoro Autonomous Region in Muslim Mindanao.<ref name="bec">Bangsamoro Education Code of 2021. Available at: https://rasmitmug.com/ebooks/Bangsamoro-Education-Code-1.pdf</ref> For MSU-IIT, which sits in a city adjacent to the Bangsamoro peace process without being formally within the BARMM, these policies are also a form of institutional positioning: a declaration that the university intends to play a substantive role in regional reconciliation.

Legacy and Cultural Significance

There is a dimension of Ditucalan's career that resists easy categorization under scholarship or administration: its symbolic function for the communities that shaped him. He represents a profile that remains rare in Philippine public life: a Maranao Muslim from Lanao del Sur who has published in Edward Elgar handbooks, studied in Kyushu, Brussels, and Cambridge, and now leads one of the country's better-ranked technological universities. That profile matters in ways that extend beyond the individual.

In his commencement addresses, including the 53rd Commencement Exercises of MSU-IIT and the 61st Commencement of MSU-Marawi, he has returned consistently to a formulation that captures his sense of obligation:

> A graduate's success is the country's hope.

The phrase sounds simple; in context, it is dense with meaning. For graduates of a university still rebuilding from the 2017 siege of Marawi City, or from an Iligan campus that received thousands of Marawi evacuees during that crisis, the injunction carries a weight that it simply would not carry at a Manila institution.<ref name="commencement-msuiit">Welcome Address by Chancellor Alizedney Ditucalan during the 53rd Commencement Ceremonies of MSU-IIT. Available at: https://www.msuiit.edu.ph/announcements/detail.php?id=1773</ref><ref name="msu-marawi-61">61st Commencement Exercises Souvenir Program, MSU Main Campus, 2024-2025. Available at: https://www.msumain.edu.ph/wp-content/uploads/2025/07/61st-Commencement-Exercises-Souvenir-Program-(2nd-Sem-2024-2025).pdf</ref>

His emergence as the first Filipino JICA long-term doctoral scholar at Kyushu, and as the first Mindanaoan recipient of the YLP fellowship, has also altered perceptions, both within the region and within the JICA network, of what Mindanao-based scholars can achieve in international competitive processes. One of the most persistent structural obstacles to Mindanao's development is the underrepresentation of Mindanao professionals and academics in the national and international networks where research agendas and policy priorities are set. Ditucalan's career has pushed, visibly and verifiably, against that pattern.

Recognition and Awards

- First alumnus of MSU-IIT to serve as Chancellor of the institution (2022)
- Youngest Chancellor in MSU-IIT's institutional history (2022)
- First grantee from Mindanao for Japan's Young Leaders' Program (YLP)
- First Filipino long-term JICA scholar at Kyushu University's Graduate School of Law
- First Filipino lawyer to undertake doctoral research specifically in competition law
- Speaker, Times Higher Education Asia Universities Summit (2023)
- MSU-IIT recognized in the Times Higher Education Impact Rankings (801–1000 band, 2022) and QS World University Rankings: Asia (551–600 band) during his chancellorship
- MSU-IIT ranked 6th among Philippine institutions in Webometrics (July 2021) and 4th in the UI GreenMetric worldwide rankings

Challenges

No account of Ditucalan's chancellorship would be complete without acknowledging the structural conditions in which it operates. MSU-IIT, for all its rankings achievements, remains a regional state university in a part of the Philippines that continues to carry the weight of decades of armed conflict, economic underdevelopment, and institutional neglect. Transforming such a university into a research-intensive institution requires not just vision and strategy but sustained external funding, stable political conditions, and a faculty pipeline that takes years to build.

The credential discrepancy around his doctoral degree, noted in scholarly sources, has not been definitively resolved by official institutional records, and remains an open question for future documentation.<ref name="pmt"/><ref name="nexus"/>

The inclusive dress code policy, while principled, was implemented in a social environment where it was not without controversy, and its long-term acceptance within the MSU-IIT community reflects an ongoing process of institutional culture change rather than a settled outcome.<ref name="pia"/>

More broadly, Ditucalan's administration faces the challenge common to any reforming leader in a complex institution: that the coherence of a vision in the chancellor's office does not automatically translate into coherence at the level of departments, programs, and individual faculty members who have their own ideas about what the university is for.

Personal Reflections

Ditucalan has spoken publicly, with characteristic directness, about what the chancellorship has demanded of him. In one exchange with the Iligan community, he admitted in the easy Visayan of everyday life in the city that, had he fully understood what the role entailed, he might have hesitated before accepting it.<ref name="one-year"/> Coming from someone whose career has been defined by taking on firsts, the remark reads less as regret than as honest testimony about the weight of institutional leadership, and about the gap between the theory of institutional design and the daily reality of running an institution through that design.

See Also

- Mindanao State University-Iligan Institute of Technology
- Mindanao State University
- Philippine Competition Act
- Philippine Competition Commission
- Young Leaders' Program (MEXT, Japan)
- JICA Knowledge Co-Creation Program
- Kyushu University
- Sarimanok Virtual Law Clinic
- Bangsamoro Autonomous Region in Muslim Mindanao
- Bangsamoro Education Code
- Marawi City
- Lanao del Sur
- Maranao people

Further Reading

- Ditucalan, Alizedney M. "The Philippine Competition Law Dilemma: US-EU Fusion and Tension." In Van Uytsel, Hayashi, and Haley (eds.), *Research Handbook on Asian Competition Law*. Cheltenham: Edward Elgar Publishing, 2020.
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